The Megaphone

ECCO EQUIPMENT CORPORATION

June 2017 | Volume 11, Issue 1

ECCO Helps Start Construction of New LA Rams Stadium

The earliest stages of construction for the stadium feature seemingly tiny ECCO vehicles dotting the landscape.

The Los Angeles Rams, as well as the San Diego Chargers, are soon to find a permanent home in a new $2.6 billion stadium being constructed where the Hollywood Park Racetrack used to stand. And to kick off this huge project, Stice Construction worked with Santa Ana's **Denny Lloyd** and hired ECCO to haul base materials for construction and excavation. This was one of the biggest projects at the Santa Ana branch in the last couple of years. ECCO was working on site for about a year and a half, helping to prepare the land for Kiewit Construction to begin building the actual stadium. As there were heavy rains throughout 2016, the stadium project was delayed and is not expected to be done in time for the 2020 NFL season.

As a part of the early stages of the construction process, ECCO had over 20 machines designed to load and haul materials on site. We had 6 40-ton Caterpillar articulated trucks, which were operated by **Gracie Moralaz**, **Victor Lozano**, **Todd Sedoris**, and **Robert Geion**, who was initially operating an 8,000 gallon water truck. ECCO also had several scrapers and 980 CAT loaders to transport concrete and other building materials, one of which was operated by **Ken Lamb**.

This project doesn't end once the stadium is built, however. Around the stadium, residences, retail areas, public parks, and even a 6000-seat performing arts theater are all going to be built. ECCO is proud to have been a part of the construction of the newest iconic regional gathering spots in Los Angeles.

ECCO Assists in Emergency Response at Oroville Dam

After the heavy rains in Northern California last winter, the degree of erosion in the Oroville dam's main spillway was so severe that a massive hole formed. As a result, the emergency spillways had to be used, and over 180,000 people living downstream had to be evacuated from their homes. Where would the city find the equipment necessary to help repair the damage from this almost-statewide disaster? ECCO Equipment, of course!

Paul McDade up in Sacramento was able to secure contracts from three different companies to get ECCO equipment on this project. Nordic Industries rented a 988F CAT loader to move rip rap material and help prevent future erosion. Great Lakes Environmental & Infrastructure rented three 40 ton haul trucks to help remove material from the basin. Teichert Construction rented four Haul Trucks, a D8T tractor and the 988F to handle all the material that had been washed down by the flow of water.

Oroville Dam's main spillway, with the middle and lower portions having been washed away by heavy water flows.

A Tribute to Stew Rhodes

Stew Rhodes, June 2013

Last month ECCO Equipment was stunned by the news that long time employee Stewart Rhodes suddenly passed away at the age of 47. He had been recovering from heart surgery and a stroke and was scheduled to return to work when one night his heart just gave out.

Stew came to work for ECCO in 2005 as the branch manager in Santa Ana, a very difficult assignment working under the watchful eyes of founders Don Schmid and Les Haug as well as GM Ross DuFrene. But Stew proved to be capable and when the opportunity arose two years later to move to Idaho and convert a few far flung Utah rentals into a local ECCO branch, Stew jumped at it. He moved his large family from the confines of southern California to the wide open spaces of Idaho. God's Country, as Stew was fond of saying.

Stew developed a customer base and found a nice piece of land to establish the yard and office, an old crop dusting runway and hangar named Frank Field. The hangar was a bit run down, so Stew oversaw the design and remodel of the office and shop space. Over the years he added other improvements such as roll up doors (that kept out the blowing snow), a large concrete apron, landscaping, and the removal of three large dilapidated out buildings. But mostly, Stew built a reputation. Honesty, fairness, hard work, respectfulness. As in all of our locations, customers associate ECCO with the characteristics of its people. So Stew was exactly the kind of representative we want to have.

The Great Recession was especially great in Idaho. The branch staff was cut from 6 to 2. But Stew always had faith that his branch would recover. And it did. In the fiscal year just ended, he brought the revenue up 73%. Profitability jumped 400%. And despite his health issues, Stew had the branch on track for another great year in 2017.
Stew leaves behind his wife Paula, five kids, two grandkids, a grateful employer, and a legacy to be proud of.

New Faces!

Brett Wilson: **Brett Wilson** joined the ECCO Phoenix team this April as a Heavy-Duty Field Tech. Brett brings 27 years of combined experience in the trucking and construction industry. Born in East Liverpool Ohio and raised in Rogers Ohio, Brett relocated to Arizona in 2006. He is the father of 4 and has 6 grandkids. Brett enjoys touring various areas on his Harley when time permits. We are pleased to have Brett on board and his work ethic has shown to be extremely positive. We feel we have found a diamond in the rough with Brett.

Shelbie Yost: Shelbie, at the young age of 25, came to North Dakota last December from Lake Elsinore with hopes of getting her CDL and landing a job driving diesels. Her uncle and father are both diesel mechanics in North Dakota, so naturally she was talented when it came to working in the yard. She found a home at ECCO and says it is a great fit for her. With her optimism and work ethic, the possibilities are endless for Shelbie as she begins her career with ECCO.

A Very New Face: Mila Jade Ferreira

Veronica Mendoza welcomed her 4th grandchild, 1st granddaughter, due on 8/5/17, which was also Grandma's birthday! She surprised us and joined the world on Memorial Day at just 30 weeks. Precious little Mila Jade Ferreira weighed 3 lbs. 9 ounces, 15 ¾ inches long. Grandma can't wait to spoil her once she is able to come home.

Employee Spotlight: Raymond McKown

Raymond, AKA "RD", McKown has been working with ECCO in Riverside for 1 1/4 years now. At the young age of 56, RD has been a local 12 operating engineer for 32 years and was in the laborers union for 8 years prior. Nowadays he loves the diversity of working for a rental company.

"RD" is an expert on crawler excavators, crawler dozers and wheel loaders. He is proficient on crawler loaders as well. We have received multiple requests for him from customers who want him back on their projects because of the work he has done for them in the past. Even our own long time mechanics and sales representatives have commented on his willingness to help out and his ability to get the job done.

Ray is a motorcycle enthusiast, Harley Davidsons in particular. He just participated in West Coast Thunder. It attracted over 7,000 riders and raised funds for veterans as well as the Riverside National Cemetery. Thanks for your participation Ray!

"RD" was also an avid dirt bike rider until the day he tore his knee up. That can definitely have a negative impact on your ability to navigate two wheels off road.

He also is a bit of a river rat. He enjoys time on the Colorado River between Big River and Lost Lake. He says the fluctuating water levels tend to thin out the crowds and leave the big boats" high and dry".

Get to the choppers! Bikers gather for the 18th annual West Coast Thunder ride.

O Canada! Goodbye to the Great White North

By David Schmid

ECCO has made the decision to close our operations in Canada. Although we feel we had an excellent team in place and were providing excellent service to our customers, it was not economically feasible to continue. Our revenues were unfortunately tied to the volatile price of oil and the whims of the giant oil companies. In addition, most of our work was performed in very remote and harsh conditions which kept our costs very high.

I want to thank Lane Barker, whom we transferred to Edmonton from sunny Las Vegas in 2012, for taking on the daunting challenge of managing the operations and improving a desperate situation. Under his leadership, costs were reduced, customers were taken care of, and the historical integrity of the ECCO brand was restored to the region. We have transferred Lane once again, this time to southern California where he is the new Service Manager, a position he held for many years in Las Vegas.

ECCO D9T working in Jasper National Park

I also want to thank our amazing dispatcher, Kelsey Ricke, who kept all the guys in line and was responsible for virtually 100% of every rental. From quote to contract to invoice to collections. We are very sorry to lose her as an asset to the company, but know that her new employer is delighted to have her.

The corporate accounting department, under Helene's leadership, also deserves thanks for figuring out how to do business in a foreign country.

Lane Barker at the entrance to ECCO's yard in Fort McKay, Alberta

From payroll, to benefits, to taxes, to insurance, to financing, to regulations, it was all new and different. I'm sure they'll be relieved after they file the last GST return!

Finally, I want to thank all the other branches for supporting the Canadian operations however they could. Some gave up equipment. Some lent mechanics (Tim Stubbs, Jay Hagerty). Some provided management (Pete Silcox, Grant Turpin). We are one company, and I am always pleased at the unselfishness of our branches and their ability to see the big picture and work for the greater good.

First/Second Quarter Anniversaries

January • February • March • April • May • June

Name	Position	Location	Years
Mendoza, Veronica	Dispatcher	Visalia	31
Johnson, Richard	Mechanic	Santa Ana	29
Lozo Jr, Lawrence	Mechanic	Riverside	29
Weed, Robin	Mechanic	Santa Ana	27
Pyle, Theron	Operator	Santa Ana	25
Schmid, David	President	Santa Ana	24
Lloyd, Dennis	Sales Rep	Santa Ana	23
Rhodes, Samuel	Mechanic	Coachella	23
Kisner, Helene	Controller	Santa Ana	22
Rohman, Bryan	Mechanic	Visalia	22
Engert, Robert	Mechanic	Las Vegas	21
Scaduto, Frank	Regional Mgr.	Visalia	21
Miles Jr., Kenneth	Vice President	Phoenix	19
Hightower, Jeff	Sales Rep	Phoenix	17
Novak, Dave	Regional Mgr.	Santa Ana	15
Chadwick, Scott	Mechanic	Stockton	15
Hagerty, James	Mechanic	Las Vegas	11
Turpin, Grant	Service Mgr.	Utah	11
Prusha, William	Mechanic	Santa Ana	9
Russell, Nelson	Regional Mgr.	North Dakota	7
Franczak, Thomas	Mechanic	Las Vegas	5
Weed, Ryan	Mechanic	Santa Ana	5
Alvarez, Francisco	Service Mgr.	Phoenix	5
McManis, Bradley	Mechanic	Phoenix	5
Stinnett, Max	Dispatcher	Phoenix	5
Dahlstrom, Hal	Sales Rep	San Diego	5
Gonzalez, Ralph	Operator	Santa Ana	5
Kuewa, Justin	Dispatcher	Las Vegas	4
Vawdrey, Curtis	Mechanic	Utah	4
McDade, Paul	Sales Rep	Sacramento	3
Centeno-Cooper, Anna	Office Mgr.	Visalia	3
Kenavey, Dennis	Sales Rep	Stockton	3
Hulett, Ryan	Mechanic	Idaho	2
Jimenez, Susana	AP	Santa Ana	2
Crumly, Wyatt	Yard Hand	Visalia	2
Madril, Arthur	Service Mgr.	Las Vegas	2
Crose, Russell	Sales Rep	Visalia	2
Parker, Lawrence	Teamster	Santa Ana	2
McKown, Raymond	Operator	Riverside	1
Rhodes, Connor	Yard Hand	Idaho	1
Siu, Tony	Senior Staff Accountant	Santa Ana	1